

Weak Two-bids

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣10

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠9

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦K

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦4

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8
♥ 10 6 5
♦ J 10 8
♣ 10 9 8 7 3

♠ 7 6 4

♥ A K 9 7 4 3

♦ 7 2

♣ Q 5



♠ J 10 9 5 3 2

♥ 8 2

♦ 9 4 3

♣ A 6

♠ K Q

♥ Q J

♦ A K Q 6 5

♣ K J 4 2

NORTH is too weak to open 1♥ but just right for 2♥.

Wow! SOUTH has 21 HCP and two good ♥s. Could this be time for a slam try?

Nope, no slam here. Suppose NORTH has six ♥s headed by the AK. The trump suit would certainly be solid, but then NORTH couldn't possibly have an outside Ace as well or he would have been too strong for a Weak-two opening. So SOUTH just bids 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♠J

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 5
♥ 4
♦ K Q 9 4
♣ K J 7 4 2

♠ K 6 4 2

♥ 5

♦ J 7 6 2

♣ A Q 9 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 3

♥ K Q J 7 6 2

♦ 8 5

♣ 8 5

♠ 10 9 7

♥ A 10 9 8 3

♦ A 10 3

♣ 10 3

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by East

Lead: ♣10

WEST really hates that 2♥ opening by EAST.

But there's no sense bidding and probably making matters worse, so she grits her teeth and passes.

If you think 3NT has a chance you are delusional.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9
♥ J 9 3
♦ Q J 7 3
♣ A Q 10 8 4

♠ K 8 4

♥ A Q 10 6 4 2

♦ 4

♣ 9 6 5



♠ 7 3 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ K 10 8 6 2

♣ 7 2

♠ A Q J 10 6 5

♥ 7

♦ A 9 5

♣ K J 3

SOUTH expects to be better off in ♠s than NORTH would be in 2♥.

Whether or not you play a new suit as a one round force or not, NORTH should make the 3♠ bid with a hand this good. SOUTH then bids the ♠ game.

West	North	East	South
	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♠9			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6		♠ Q J 10 8 3
♥ A Q J 8 7 5 4		♥ 10 9
♦ 6 3 2		♦ A 8
♣ 8 4		♣ K J 10 7
	N W E S	♠ A K 7 5 ♥ K 6 3 ♦ K Q J 5 4 ♣ A
		♠ 9 4 2
		♥ 2
		♦ 10 9 7
		♣ Q 9 6 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♦	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by West			
Lead: ♠Q			

WEST has a pretty normal 3♥ opening bid.

EAST, however, has a big hand, and she launches into Blackwood.

When WEST shows one Ace EAST can bid 6♥ with confidence.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 4 2
♥ A 10 8 5 4
♦ 8 4 2
♣ 4

♠ A Q 10
♥ K Q J
♦ Q J 10 3
♣ A J 10



♠ K 7 6 5
♥ 9 3 2
♦ A K 6 5
♣ 6 3

♠ J 3
♥ 7 6
♦ 9 7
♣ K Q 9 8 7 5 2

SOUTH doesn't have much of a 3♣ opening bid.

But NORTH has just the type of hand you need to bid 3NT after partner's preempt. The other three suits well stopped, and certain entry in Opener's long suit. Notice here that 3NT is a good contract, but 5♣ would go down 1.

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		3♣
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♦ K			

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q 6 3

♥ Q 8 2

♦ A K Q

♣ K Q J

♠ K 9 8 2

♥ A 4

♦ 10 9 2

♣ 10 9 7 5



♠ J 4

♥ K J 10 9 6 3

♦ 8 7 5

♣ 4 2

♠ 10 7 5

♥ 7 5

♦ J 6 4 3

♣ A 8 6 3

When EAST opens with a Weak 2♥ bid, WEST knows she will force to game but is thinking about slam.

But first she needs to know if EAST has anything extra. She bids 2NT to get more information.

EAST returns to ♥s to show bare minimum so WEST settles for game.

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♦4